

RELATIONSHIPS ARE NOT SIMPLE ON THE BACKEND



Matrimony.com, which adds over 12000 new subscribers on a daily basis makes use of IBMs latest technology solution not only to measure insights but also for the accurate prediction of matches from several petabytes of data.

methods, and the Oakland Athletics' competitive advantage was reduced within the next two seasons.

Conclusion: statistical analysis in sports is tricky business – there's definitely an edge to be gained if you're onto something, but the ubiquitous nature of statistics and the huge number of people working on them will ensure that the advantage is quickly evened out between rivals. What starts out as a competitive advantage one day soon becomes the bare minimum to be matched the next day. Another point is that success in sport always has – and always will – include the element of blind, stupid luck. No amount of mathematics can completely resolve

the fine margins of uncertainty or account for human error (or genius) that so often almost singlehandedly decides the fates of teams. However, statisticians continue to drill deeper into all numbers available – and, indeed, try to obtain more of them – in search of even the smallest of payoffs, however short-lived those may be.

Order from chaos – 'Insight' and 'Expected Goals (xG)'

We take a look at two of the most prominent applications of big data analytics to sports today: ESPNcricinfo's number-crunching tool, 'Insight', and an emerging way of analysing football matches that attempts complex analysis while retaining footballing sense amidst the confusion – the Expected Goals (xG) method.

ESPNcricinfo has established itself as the de-facto standard for official match statistics. It has lived a remarkable life. Beginning life in 1993 as a bot on the IRC (Internet Relay Chat) cricket channel that provided score updates on request, it had its own website and had catalogued all the test matches ever played by 1995. Over the next few years, its live coverage of matches made it extremely popular all over the world, which led to its acquisition by the Wisden group in 2003, and within 2 years Cricinfo was capable of